

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: East

Board: 5

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3♦

Declarer: South

**Board 1**

North Deals  
None Vul

♠ 10 7 6 5  
♥ J 10 6 2  
♦ 8  
♣ A 8 4 2

♠ A K 9 2  
♥ A 8 7 4  
♦ K 4 2  
♣ J 10



♠ 8 4 3  
♥ 9 5  
♦ A 7 3  
♣ K Q 9 5 3

♠ Q J  
♥ K Q 3  
♦ Q J 10 9 6 5  
♣ 7 6

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              | 1NT   | 2♦   | 2NT   |
| Pass         | 3♣    | Pass | 3NT   |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 3NT by North |       |      |       |

Partner's 2NT is the lebensohl convention. He requests that you bid 3♣ as a relay, which you do. Partner now bids 3NT.

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When partner bids 3NT AFTER the lebensohl 2NT, he is suggesting you play there, and he guarantees a stopper in their suit. You are happy to pass.

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♦Q. East attacks in ♦s and you must make an immediate choice. Hold up, win in dummy, or win in your hand.

Winner List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 0 :: Total = 5

First decide about what to do at trick #1. If you hold up and East plays another ♦, no harm will be done. But probably no good will be done either because East is likely to have 6 ♦s, leaving West with just a singleton anyway. But what if East pockets the one ♦ trick and switches to ♥s, a suit where you only have one stopper? Since that might turn out badly, you should **NOT** hold up.

As to which hand to win it in, that's easy. You need to preserve any dummy entries that you can so you win the first trick with your ♦K.

Now you establish some ♣ winners. You play the ♣J and both defenders play low.

You have to assume that defenders good enough to hold up their ♣A at the first opportunity will be good enough to do it on the second play also. But you can thwart them by next playing your ♣10 and overtaking with dummy's ♣Q. Even if they do hold up again you can continue with another ♣ from dummy to establish the suit while you still have the ♦A for an entry.

If you fail to overtake the second ♣ West will hold up the ♣A again.

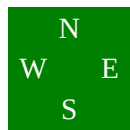
Then you will lose all those ♣ tricks in dummy.

**Board 3**

North Deals  
E-W Vul

♠ 5 3  
♥ A J 8 6 2  
♦ 7 5 2  
♣ K J 9

♠ K J 7  
♥ K 5 3  
♦ A Q J 8  
♣ 7 5 3



♠ A Q 8 2  
♥ Q 10 9  
♦ K 10 4  
♣ A 10 6

♠ 10 9 6 4  
♥ 7 4  
♦ 9 6 3  
♣ Q 8 4 2

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
|          | 1♦    | 1NT  | Pass  |
| 2♦       | Pass  | 2♥   | Pass  |
| 3NT      | Pass  | 4♥   |       |
| All Pass |       |      |       |

4♥ by East

The contract would be 4♥ played by West.

East plays 4♥. South leads the ♦9. North wins the first trick with the ♦A, then plays ♦Q. You take your ♦K now, fearing that the next one could be ruffed by South.

Loser List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 5

You hope North, who opened the bidding, (as South before the hands were rotated), will have the ♠K, which would reduce your losers to 4.

You win the second ♦ and play your ♥Q, taken by North with the ♥K. He cashes the ♦J, South following, then exits with a small ♥.

Win this trump and play one more, pulling North's last trump and ending in dummy. Play a ♠ to your ♠Q (which wins) then play ♠A and ruff a ♠ in dummy. North follows with the ♠7, ♠J and ♠K. Now you must try the ♣ finesse, but through whom?

Is it a 50-50 guess? Or is North more likely to have the ♣Q since he had the opening hand?

No, it is not a 50-50 guess. No, North doesn't have the ♣Q, South does. If you watched the cards that North has played you will realize he started with 3-3-4-3 distribution. You will also know that he started with 14 points outside the ♣ suit. If he had the ♣Q he would have a balanced 16 point hand and would have opened 1NT, not 1♦. So South has the ♣Q.

You can go through 100 hands and on 99 of them it won't matter if you pay attention to the cards played by the defenders or not.

But if you don't pay attention on all 100 of them you will miss the one time where your attention was needed.

The question is: Do you use Transfers after a 1NT OVERCALL? And in particular, can you bid the opponent's suit and have it mean a transfer instead of a cue-bid? This is something you and your partner need to agree on - as for me and my partner, we think 2♦ is a transfer. Partner replies 2♥.

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With 10 points you are between Invitational and Game-forcing. Which means you bid either 2NT or 3NT, whichever suits your fancy. Today let's say it is 3NT which partner converts to 4♥.

**Board 5**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 10 2

♥ J 8 6

♦ A 3

♣ J 7 4 2

♠ 8 6 5 4

♥ A K 2

♦ Q 4

♣ A K 10 3



♠ A K 9

♥ Q 10 5 4

♦ J 10 9

♣ Q 8 6

♠ 7 3

♥ 9 7 3

♦ K 8 7 6 5 2

♣ 9 5

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

2♠

Pass

3♣

Pass

3♦

All Pass

3♦ by South

Loser List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = ? : ♣ = 0 :: Total = 3 + ?

Rather than trying to figure out how many losers this ♦ holding may produce, approach it from the other direction; you can only afford ONE loser, so you assume the cards lie in a way that will give you that result.

That means that the ♦s must be splitting 3-2, and it also means that you must knock out the ♦A without using either the ♦K or ♦Q. Can you do it?

Your only hope is for West to hold a doubleton ♦ A x. You ruff the third ♠, then play a small ♦ toward dummy's ♦ Q. When this wins the trick, play another ♦, and duck in your hand. If West's ♦ A falls you will be golden.

There are times when your only hope of making a contract is if the defender's cards lie in a particular way.

When this happens you should play as if they actually **DO** lie in that way, even though it may be against the percentages.

This hand is a perfect example - your only hope was for West to hold ♦ A x, so - you base your plan on West holding ♦ A x.

In the old days (before transfer bids) you could have just bid a "drop-dead" 2♦. But those days are gone so you must improvise. You bid 2♠, transferring partner to ♣s.

Partner says 3♣;

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Partner says 3♣;

You now bid 3♦ and partner knows to pass.

South plays 3♦. West leads the ♠Q. East overtakes and plays ♠ A K 9.